CURATORIAL COMMISSION DOSSIER

Absheron Tectonics: Primordial Matter & Geological Strata

Submitted in Formal Response to the Selection Brief | Gazelli Art House (London / Baku)

> *"True regional modernism does not decorate with heritage; it builds directly from the primordial substances of the land: crystallized pink salt, volcanic craquelure, and ancient hydrocarbons."*

Responding to the international fine art standards of **Gazelli Art House**, this 5-work suite channels the pioneering spirit of the **Absheron Modernist School** (Javad Mirjavadov, Sattar Bahlulzade, Rasim Babayev, Tofig Javadov). Abandoning superficial decorative clichés and carpet motifs, the artist explores authentic Absheron signatures through radical mineral materiality and Caspian scientific taxonomy.

PLATE	ARTWORK TITLE	DIMENSIONS	PRIMARY ABSHERON MATERIAL	CASPIAN MOTIF
01	*Luminescence of Masazir Dawn*	185 × 120 cm	Masazir Pink Lake Salt, Plaster	Lacustrine Evaporites
02	*The Shebeke Reliquary: Fossil Didacna*	40 × 60 cm	Limestone Ground, Shell Accents	*Didacna* Cockle Shells
03	*The Binagadi Derrick: Hydrocarbon Strata*	80 × 100 cm	Binagadi Bitumen, Pyrite Ore	Caspian Marine Shad
04	*Breath of Lokbatan: Volcanic Crater & Goby*	180 × 180 cm	Volcanic Clay, Celadon Glazes, Pyrite	Caspian Tadpole Goby
05	*The Gobustan Solar Oracle: Lamprey*	100 × 150 cm	Beach Sand, Lake Salt, Plaster	Caspian Lamprey Mandala

Faunal Taxonomy & Caspian Strategy: The suite deliberately privileges archaic benthic survivors (*Didacna*, *Alosa*, *Benthophilus*, *Caspiomyzon*) to represent primordial antiquity. The iconic **Caspian Seal (*Pusa caspica*)** is honored through the serene lacustrine sanctuaries of Masazir, with an authorial figurative study documented in studio archives as an available companion acquisition.

Archival Conservation Protocol: All raw minerals are stabilized under museum standards: Masazir salt crystals undergo thermal dehydration and UV-matte acrylic encapsulation; mud-volcano craquelure is co-polymerized for zero shedding; and bitumen is mineral-dissolved into inert polymer glazes.

PLATE 01 • PURE MINERAL ABSTRACTION

Luminescence of Masazir Dawn

Masazır Şəfəqi: Çəhrayı Duz Gölü



DIMENSIONS	**185 × 120 cm** (Horizontal Landscape Canvas, Specification from Brief)
MATERIALS	Genuine Masazir Pink Lake Salt, Porous Absheron Limestone Plaster, Heavy Impasto, Incised Sgraffito
CURATORIAL CONCEPT	An ethereal, meditative abstract landscape capturing the tranquil morning horizon over Lake Masazir. Where misted pastel-pink saline waters meet white crystalline shores, thick palette-knife impasto sculpts the organic coastline, embedded with coarse pink-and-white mineral crystals that glisten naturally in ambient light. Scored with delicate geometric sgraffito fissures in the mineral foreground, this composition embodies pure lacustrine serenity. (Pure geological abstraction; zero portraits, zero figures, zero carpets).
TURNKEY MOUNTING	Mineral Impasto Continuous Wrap (or dark walnut floater) • Dual Aluminum French Cleats (~14.5 kg) • 2700K Warm Wash Lighting

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PLATE 02 • MIXED-MEDIA PAINTING ON CANVAS

The Shebeke Reliquary: Fossil Didacna in Absheron Stone

Şəbəkə Qalığı: Qədim Didakna və Daş Pəncərə



DIMENSIONS	**40 × 60 cm** (Vertical Format Canvas, Specification from Brief)
MEDIUM / TECHNIQUES	Mixed-Media Oil & Mineral Pigments on Stretched Canvas, Absheron Limestone Ground, Heavy Palette-Knife Impasto, Subtle Embedded *Didacna* Shell Elements, Turquoise & Lapis Lazuli Glazes
ENDEMIC ORGANISM	Caspian Cockle (*Didacna trigonoides* / *Didacna pyramidata*)
CURATORIAL CONCEPT	An intimate mixed-media painting on canvas honoring Absheron's stone-carving traditions (*daş yonma*). Thick palette-knife impasto and porous limestone-sand grounds evoke the tactile presence of Baku stone, framing an intricate painted Shebeke geometric window. Luminous glazes of Caspian turquoise and lapis lazuli glow within the tracery, accentuated by finely embedded small *Didacna* cockle shells providing delicate, low-relief tactile dimensionality to the canvas surface.
TURNKEY MOUNTING	Limestone Gesso Wrap (or blackened steel floater) • Single Aluminum Cleat w/ Locking Pin (~3.2 kg) • 2700K-3000K Spot (15° Beam)

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PLATE 03 • INDUSTRIAL-GEOLOGICAL ABSTRACTION

The Binagadi Derrick: Hydrocarbon Strata & Pyrite Shad

Binaqədi Buruğu: Qara Qızıl və Pirit Şad



DIMENSIONS	**80 × 100 cm** (Vertical Format Canvas, Specification from Brief)
MEDIUM / TECHNIQUES	Raw Unrefined Binagadi Bitumen, Pyrite Sulfide Aggregates, Chalky Limestone Contrast Sgraffito, Oil & Industrial Asphaltite Knife Impasto
ENDEMIC WILDLIFE	Caspian Marine Shad / Brazhnikov's Shad (*Alosa braschnikowi*)
CURATORIAL CONCEPT	Confronting Baku's historic role as the pioneer of world petroleum, minimal structural scaffolding beams inspired by historic wooden oil derricks slice across visceral slabs of pitch-black Binagadi bitumen. Leaping through the dark matrix is an armored Caspian marine shad adorned with metallic golden pyrite ore, set above the eternal subterranean gas flame (*Yanar Dağ / Ateshgah*).
TURNKEY MOUNTING	Bitumen Polymer Continuous Wrap • Heavy-Duty French Cleat (~6.8 kg) • 3000K Museum Track Lighting (Highlight Pyrite)

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PLATE 04 • EARTH-ART VORTEX • GEOTHERMAL MINERAL PAINTING

Breath of Lokbatan: Volcanic Crater and Armored Goby

Lökbatan Nəfəsi: Palçıq Vulkanı və Zirehli Qobi



DIMENSIONS	**180 × 180 cm** (Monumental Square Format 1:1, Specification from Brief)
MATERIALS	Subterranean Lokbatan Mud-Volcano Clay, Luminous Caspian Celadon & Seafoam Glazes, Tactile Mineral Craquelure, Metallic Pyrite Vein Infiltration
CURATORIAL CONCEPT	A monumental square statement uniting subterranean geothermal energy with aquatic serenity. An aerial vortex of an active mud-volcano crater rendered in thick palette-knife impasto and authentic mud clay craquelure fissures opens into luminous, flowing glazes of Caspian celadon and seafoam green. Gliding through the geothermal currents, an armored Caspian tadpole goby (*Benthophilus*) gleams with metallic pyrite veins, harmonizing primordial geological power with tranquil ecological resilience.
TURNKEY MOUNTING	Volcanic Craquelure Gallery Wrap • Triple Aluminum French Cleats (~19.5 kg) • High-CRI 98 Wall Wash (Grazing Texture)

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PLATE 05 • MYTHOLOGICAL ARCHAEOLOGICAL TOTEM

The Gobustan Solar Oracle: Ouroboros Lamprey

Qobustan Günəşi: İlanbalığı və Qədim Qaya Təsvirləri



DIMENSIONS	**100 × 150 cm** (Vertical Portrait Canvas, Specification from Brief)
MEDIUM / TECHNIQUES	Absheron Coastal Beach Sand Mandala, Masazir Salt Encrustations, Incised Gobustan Petroglyphic Sgraffito, Oil & Bone Plaster on Linen
ENDEMIC WILDLIFE	Caspian Lamprey (*Caspiomyzon wagneri*)
CURATORIAL CONCEPT	A transcendental contemporary altar piece uniting prehistoric rock art with ecological mystery. The ancient Caspian lamprey coils into an Ouroboros circle of eternity around a concentric sand-and-salt solar mandala. Incised directly into the bone-plaster and limestone ground are Gobustan petroglyphs (reed boats, hunters, and sacred solar bulls), immortalizing Absheron's ancient rock art heritage within deep cosmological time.
TURNKEY MOUNTING	Bone Plaster Gallery Edge (or oiled walnut floater) • Dual Aluminum Z-Cleats (~11.0 kg) • 2700K Framing Projector / Gimbal

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SPATIAL INTEGRATION • CONTRACTOR SPECIFICATIONS

In-Situ Spatial Context & Structural Mounting Matrix

Photorealistic Architectural Previews on Honed Absheron Coquina Walls



Plate 01: Honed Coquina Feature Wall • Executive Salon Placement

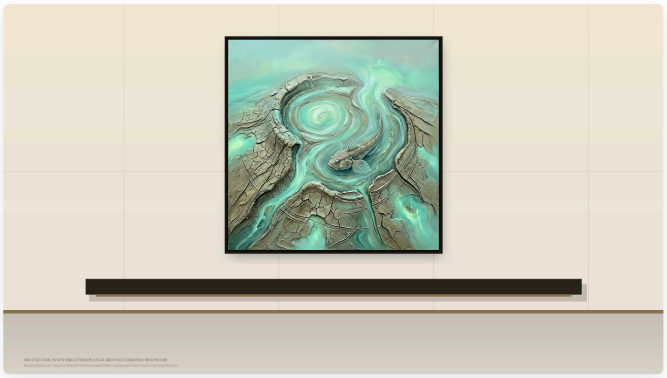


Plate 04: Grand Double-Height Atrium • 2700K Ceiling Wash Lighting

PLATE	DIMENSIONS	EST. WEIGHT	EDGE / FRAMING PROFILE	RIGGING HARDWARE	OPTIMAL LIGHTING
01	185 × 120 cm	~14.5 kg	Continuous Mineral Wrap / Floater	Dual Aluminum Z-Cleats	2700K Ceiling Wash (CRI 95+)
02	40 × 60 cm	~3.2 kg	Limestone Gesso / Black Steel	Single Cleat w/ Locking Pin	2700K-3000K Spot (15°)
03	80 × 100 cm	~6.8 kg	Bitumen Polymer / Bronze Floater	Heavy-Duty French Cleat (50kg)	3000K Museum Track Light
04	180 × 180 cm	~19.5 kg	Volcanic Craquelure Wrap	Triple Cleats (Seismic Rated)	High-CRI 98 Wall Grazing
05	100 × 150 cm	~11.0 kg	Bone Plaster / Oiled Walnut	Dual Aluminum Z-Cleats	2700K Framing Projector

CURATORIAL MATERIAL PALETTE BOX ("THE TACTILE VERIFICATION")

Mirgasim Art Studio offers to deliver a bespoke hand-crafted presentation box containing five 15 × 15 cm cured architectural plaques (Masazir lake salt in UV-acrylic, Lokbatan clay craquelure, cold-polymerized Binagadi bitumen, honed Absheron coquina, and pyrite ore aggregates) for direct tactile review by the selection committee.